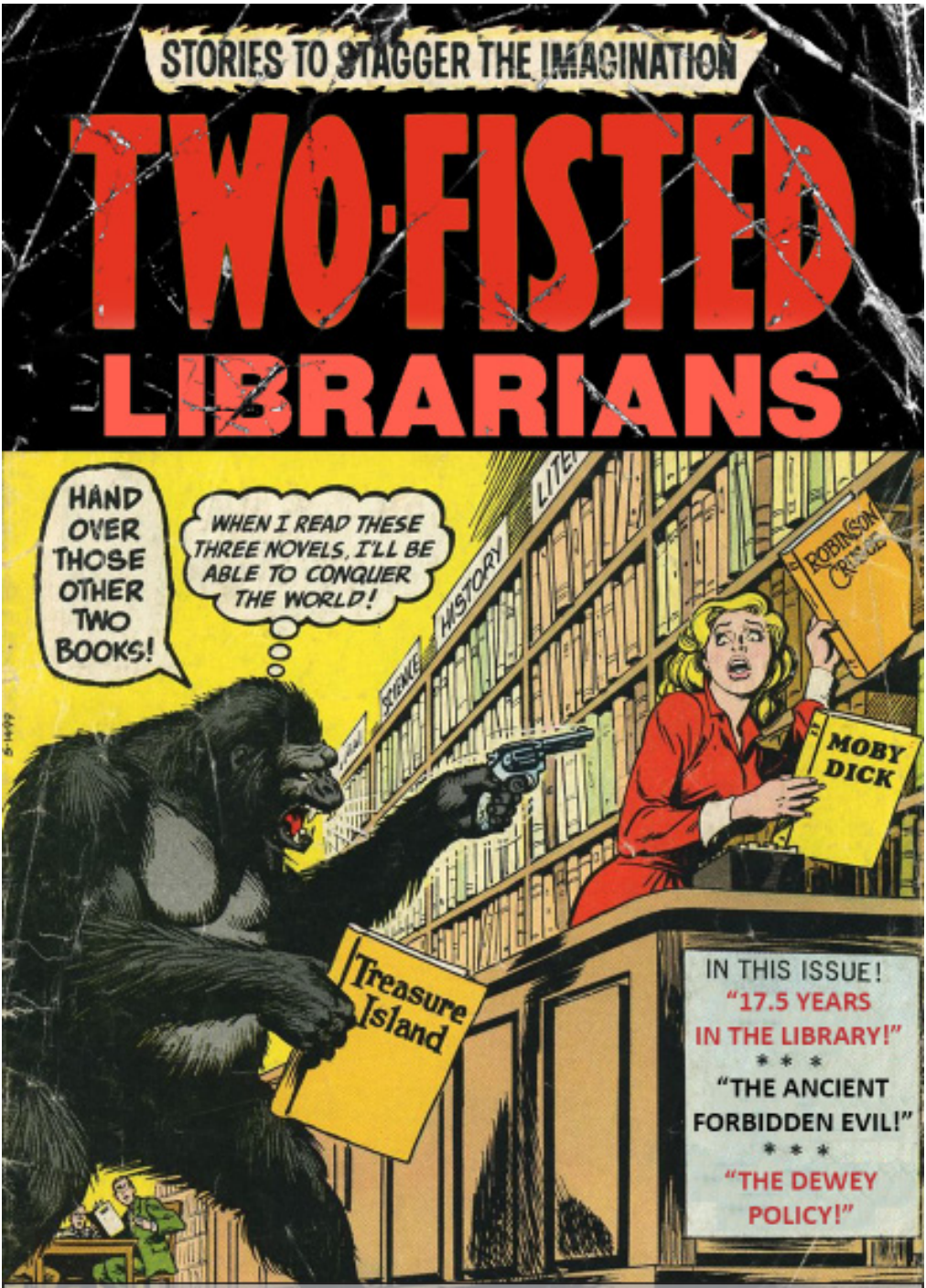


"A title just begging to be made!"

Mike Mignola, creator of Hellboy

Other content, layout, design, and remixes by Matthew Murray

FAQ

Who drew the cover image?
Cover image by Nick Cardy. Originaly published in From Beyond the Unknown #23, July 1973.

Who drew the back page image?
The original, unedited, image was by Taren Riley.

Hey! Did Mike Mignola actually say that?
Yes! He said it after I gave him a copy at the 2015 Emerald City Comicon.

Has he actually read Two Fisted Librarians?
I have no idea. Probably not.

Two Fisted Librarians #3. Published June 2015, Vancouver, BC.

I spent 17.5 years in the library for a job I did not want

By Annie Gaines

I spent 17 ½ years in the library for a job that I did not want. Once I was hired, I was contracted to 6 years of work before tenure, and I fought to make tenure before my personal convictions were reversed and I was finally fired. Despite the devastation that my termination wreaked upon my life and my family, my most important experiences really had nothing to do with my job.

Prior to working in the library, I knew nothing about librarians and, like most of society, I couldn't have cared less. I assumed that all people in libraries belonged there, and that they deserved whatever happened to them.

Nothing could be further from the truth.

I learned that librarians are just people like you and me. Their experiences may have been very different from ours and they have clearly made some bad choices, but these people are not monsters. Instead they are our friends, neighbors, yoga instructors and bartenders. They have the same wants, needs and desires that we all do, and they very much want to do better. It is criminal for society to turn their backs on libraries and librarians and treat them as if they are irredeemable, for most are not. They just need some help from others -- as we all do at some time in our lives.

Recognizing these basic facts is the first step toward improving the lives of librarians. Next we must change the library industrial complex from a

paramilitary organizations designed to work with almost nothing to systems that realize that members of our community need the resources libraries can provide and we need to treat them as such. Libraries as currently structured are abusive, coercive, and destructive to people's self esteem, abilities, and families. Warehousing books in the Library Industrial Complex accomplishes nothing and returns books to society more damaged than when they initially entered the system.

Realistic case management, evaluation, and treatment will lead to rehabilitation, a better library experience, and a better future for the books upon their release. Services should be provided according to the needs and experiences of each person. Education and job training will provide librarians with the necessary tools to change their lives; more importantly it will give them hope.

*****

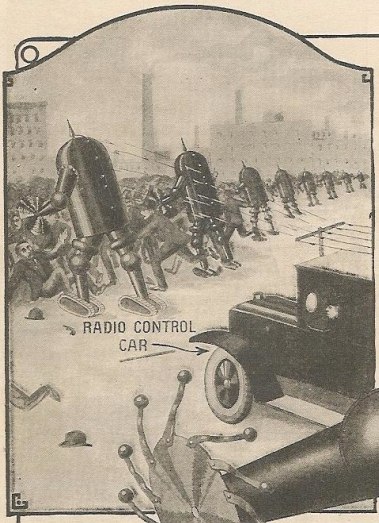
This story was adapted from t he article "I spent 17.5 years in prison for a crime I did not commit" from http://www.huffingtonpost.com/ravishly/i-spent-17-years-in-pris_b_6124808.html

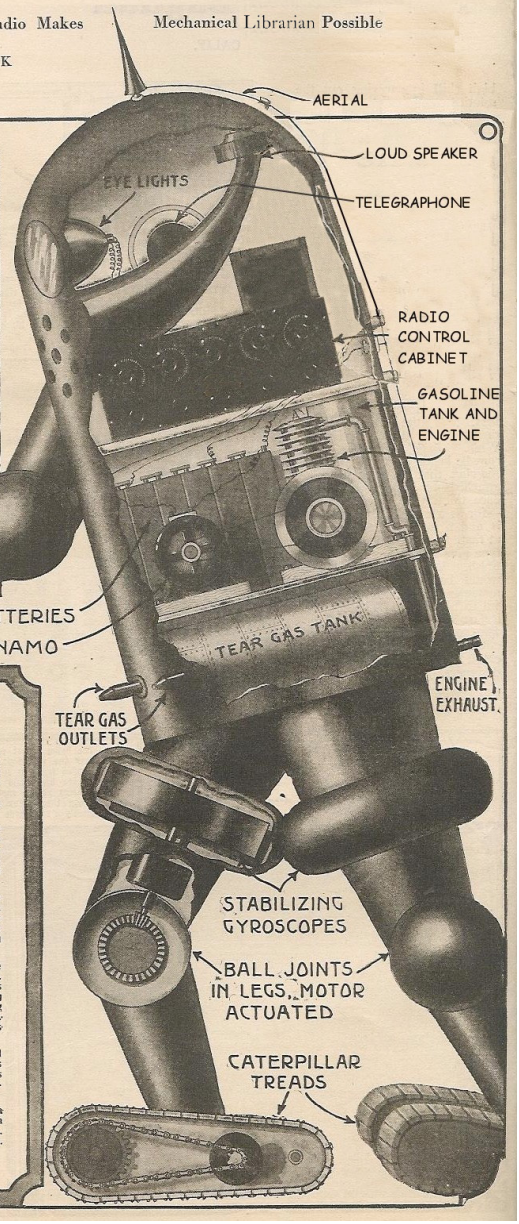
From Brenda Starr Comics #13 (September, 1947). "Invitation to a - Dance?". Illustrated by Dale Messick.

Radio Librarian Automaton

Distant Control by Radio Makes Mechanical Librarian Possible

By H. GERNSBACK





As is well known, radio can be used today to produce mechanical effects at a distance. This new art is known as radio-tele-mechanics. Many years ago already it was possible to start and operate vehicles and machinery entirely by radio. The United States Navy a little over a year ago operated the warship "Iowa" entirely by radio. The firing of the boilers, the steering of the ship and all the controls were entirely effected by radio.

The Radio Automaton as disclosed on this page and in our cover design is therefore not a wild dream, but it can be constructed by any one with means available today. The Radio Automaton contains the machinery as shown in our illustration which comprises a gasoline engine, a radio control cabinet, a telegraphone, a loud speaker, a gyroscope and other auxiliary apparatus.

The Automaton is kept erect by the stabilizing gyroscopes. The machine does not really walk like a human being, but rather glides along the road over all obstacles by the small caterpiller tractors attached to the feet. This makes it unnecessary for the Automaton to take steps, and the machine will therefore progress by a gliding motion which is quite rapid.

Such a machine would seem to be exceedingly valuable to disperse mobs, or for war purposes and even for industrial purposes. In the upper illustration is shown the police car which controls all the movements of a regiment of such automata. For fighting mobs use is made of tear gas which is stored in a tank under pressure and which alone will quickly disperse a mob if necessary. The arms are provided with rotating discs which carry lead balls on flexible leads. These act as police clubs in action.

For night attack the Automaton is provided with eye-lights and the loud speaker is used to shout orders to the mob which orders can be given direct from the radio control car. Inasmuch as this car is always in the rear of the Automata it can watch their movements and direct them as necessitated by circumstances.

As a close hand-to-hand fighting machine the Radio Automata have no equal. Bullets do not affect them and if equipped with a twenty to forty H.P. engine, they will be well nigh irresistible. They probably have no superior for fighting mobs or for war purposes.

I'll Make an Archivist Out of You

By Adena Brons

Let's get down to business to defeat...the FONDS.
Did they send me files with no archival bond?
You're a mildewed bunch of photographs
but you can bet before we're through,
somehow I'll digitize all of youuuuu

Created during business
with unbroken custody
Transferred to an archive
for authenticity
You're not in acid-free envelopes
and there's rusty staples too
Somehow I will appraise all of youuuu

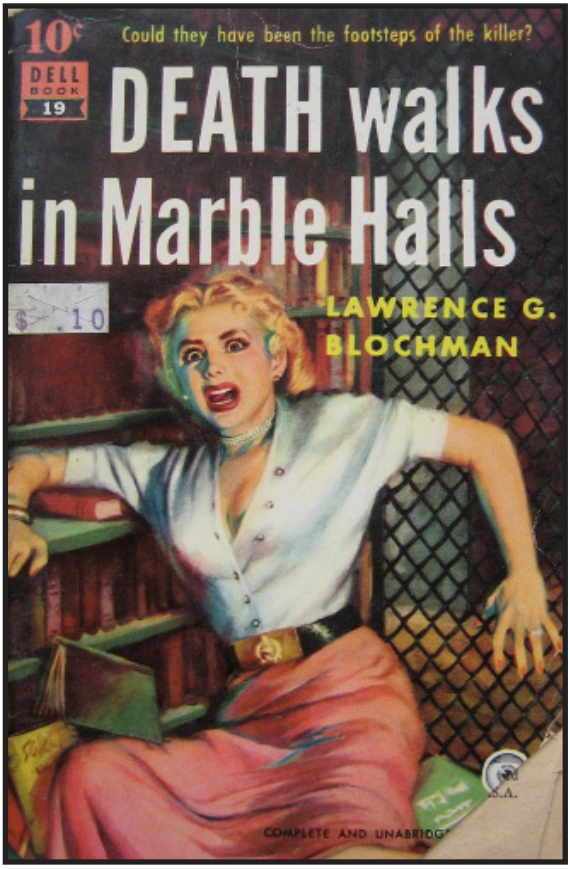
I'm never gonna get this done
Fifty feet of processed records
Boy was I fool to miss the symposium

Luciana's got 'em scared to death
Not another 12 page paper!
Now I really wish I stayed a librarian!

We use RAD
We must maintain the original order
We use RAD
Respect des fonds and evidentiality
We use RAD
We keep our temperatures nice and chilly
And monitor the vault's relative humidity

Time is racing t'ward us, as online files decay
Using diplomatics might save the day!
They're dispositive or probative
But you haven't got a clue
How could you be an archivist too?

We use RAD
We must maintain the original order
We use RAD
Respect des fonds and evidentiality
We use RAD
We keep our temperatures nice and chilly
And monitor the vault's relative humidity



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Parent's Signature _____

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THE DEWEY POLICY

By Robert Perret

Mack Spire watched as his own blood dripped from the custom brass knuckles adorning the fists of Arnold Goldblatt, senior acquisitions librarian and heavy for the International Library Kabal, also known as ILK.

OVER read one fist. DÜE☠ read the other. The umlaut seemed excessive. The skull seemed trite. They both punched just fine.

"I like to think I'm not unreasonable," said the clipped voice from behind the halo of the halogen reading lamp pointed directly in Mack's eyes. Imelda Gutierrez, Head Inquisitor of the Special Friends of the Library, tugged at her shirt cuffs in mild agitation. "You knew what the game was when you volunteered for library school. We all did. No one becomes a librarian to be a saint. You come for the money and you stay for the power." She nodded curtly at Arnold.

OVER. DÜE☠.

"We all give lip service to the idea that information wants to be free. And then we all go in the staff lounge and laugh. All except you." Nod.

OVER. DÜE☠.

"The truth is, information wants to get paid. Cash money. Even more important is that information's pimp, the librarian, needs to get her taste." Nod.

OVER. DÜE☠.

"And I need to get mine." Nod.

OVER. DÜE☠.

"I can't get mine if you don't gets yours, Mack Spire. Instead you just keep on handing out books like they grow on trees. So, since you refuse to get yours you're about to get what you've got coming instead." Nod.

Throughout this oration Mack had simply smirked and absorbed the blows and continued fingering the rope binding his hands behind the chair. As the punishing knuckles of Arnold Goldblatt rose once

again Mack spat blood and observed. “There’s one thing you’ve forgotten about library school.”

“I forget nothing. I still have the scars,” she said, absentmindedly rubbing her arms.

“They don’t just teach you how to tie a librarian’s knot,” he said throwing off his binds. “They teach you how to untie one too.” He grabbed a length of the now loose rope in both hands and deftly wrapped it around the neck of Arnold while stepping behind him. Mack pulled, hard. Arnold made a wheezing sound and then his body went slack. Mack pushed the dead mass so it fell onto Imelda, pinning her to the floor.

“Library police! Library police!” Imelda yelled! Her jackbooted thugs were already kicking down the door without even trying the handle first. Mack knew he had just seconds. He scampered up the chute to the mouth of the bookdrop. Unable to fit through the child safe metal flap at the top he flipped around and brought both feet to bear with a might double kick fueled by adrenaline and the entire facade of the drop jarred loose and fell to the sidewalk outside. Mack squeezed through the opening. At the curb on a moped waited Daisy Trueheart, children’s library aide and Mack’s accomplice. Her sensible shoe rested lightly upon the throttle, gently revving it so that the moped could leap away from the curb at a moment’s notice. Watching the rhythmic motion of her lythe calf ensconced in argyle socks that seemed to climb forever until disappearing beneath the hem of her upcycled vintage dress kept Mack’s motor revved as well. But this was no time for amoré. He could already hear the ILK thugs exiting through the front door of the library, their vicious knives and black ops guns each setting off the beeping security gate in turn.

“It’s time to book,” she laughed over her shoulder. Mack jumped on the back of the moped and she peeled rubber at a moderate speed and merged carefully into the flow of traffic. “Next stop the honeymoon suite overlooking Niagara Falls!”

“Not yet,” Mack said through gritted teeth.

“But, Mack! You promised! The Greater Wullenoch Area Municipal Library was supposed to be the last one.”

“I know, baby.” Mack said, gently grasping her porcelain chin between the rough calloused fingers of a front line librarian, gazing deeply

through her cateye glasses and into her soul. Daisy's heart skipped a beat and the moped skipped a curb and briefly fishtailed before stabilizing again. "But we'll never be safe, none of us, until the library-industrial complex has their fingers out of the common man's pockets and back up to their shushing lips where librarian fingers belong!"

"Oh, Mack!" Daisy swooned. Mack put his well-practiced finger to her well-practiced lips to hush her womanly protestations and then reached around her to steer the moped right to the heart of the ILK conspiracy - the Library of Congress - Washington, D.C.

When they arrived corruption hung in the air like a humid morass. Behind all of these marble pillars and mythological friezes and noble inscriptions beat the corrupt heart of freedom's enemies. One of the ventricles of this dark heart was ILK, and Mack was here to stop one kind of beating with another. When the Library of Congress finally loomed over Mack and Daisy the only available parking was reserved for the handicapped so they had to circle back out and away a few blocks but finally found a nice spot with some shade and easy curb access. The smack of their orthopedic soles on the rough concrete sidewalks felt good as they ran up to and ultimately inside the building. They danced in, out, and through the rapidly moving crowd in the public lobby but were stopped by a couple of thick necked guards just outside the staff door.

The one had a large magnifying glass he kept powerfully thwacking into the opposite palm. The other had a newspaper impaled on a stick resting over his shoulder. "Whats do youse want?" Magnifying Glass asked. Mack stepped up close to block the view of the room at large and quickly gave Tweedle-Dee and Tweedle-Dum each the Secret Librarian Handshake in turn. Newspaper Stick grunted in disappointment and then jutted his stubbly chin at Daisy. "Whats abouts the dame?"

"Relax you unabridged dictionary of a goon," Mack quipped. "This dame is with me."

"Always, Mack!" Daisy gasped suddenly very flushed and in need of Mack's arm to steady her.

Neither of the goons looked too happy but neither had the brains to question Library Policy and Library Policy said the secret handshake opens the door. Mack and Daisy passed through quickly. Just

with books. Some had been here so long a thick layer of dust had gathered. Daisy gasped and recoiled. “Mack! I don’t understand! It’s all so terrible! All of these books, just sitting back here where no one can get to them.”

“It’s all part of the game, sweetheart.” Max smiled knowingly to himself. “If books were too easy to get the people wouldn’t need librarians. At least, that’s what the small minds that reside in high places think. By keeping the books people really need locked up back here where no one can get to them they keep their petty principalities.”

“It’s just too awful to think about!” Daisy fell back into Mack’s arms and pulled herself up against him by the tweedy lapels of his sportcoat. Her perfume filled his nose and her hot breath caressed his ear. She been pulling the old fainting lady routine a lot, lately, Mack observed. But then again women were always throwing themselves at him. It was a male librarian’s lot in life to endure an ongoing onslaught of attempted romantic jiu jitsu by the female sex.

As they headed back towards the office of the Librarian of Congress each found their hands wandering as if with a mind of their own and grasping, not each other, but a book off of one of the carts they passed. This was only natural as a librarian without a book in the hand is like a lion without teeth. Mack’s hand had naturally found its way around a Robert Ludlum thriller, a shadowy figure fleeing from a backlit helicopter on the cover. Daisy’s daintly fingers grasped at *100 Kitsch-free Ideas for your Retro Glam Wedding!* The big-eyed bride and groom cats on the floral print cover belied the very premise of the tome.

Finally the heavy oak door they had come all this way to kick down was in front of them. Upon the frosted glass insert in gold leaf read “Sherman Fairweather, Librarian of Congress.” Mack brought his leg back for a mighty kick when Daisy gently laid a hand upon his arm. “Wait, Mack!” She pleaded demurely. “If we go around kicking doors down we are no better than ILK and others of their ilk.”

Mack couldn’t deny his raven-bunned beau anything so he returned his raised foot to the ground and instead rapped insistently upon the door.

“Who dares disturb the Librarian of Congress!” came a weedy voice from inside.

“Mack Spire, renegade librarian, and his companion Daisy True

heart, girl library aide!" Mack bellowed. Daisy liked the sound of both their names coming from Mack's lips in the same sentence.

"Mr. Spire." Sherman Fairweather sneered. "We have been waiting for you. I believe you will find that your Library Association membership has been revoked." Mack quickly pulled out his wallet and flipped it open. It was true. The card emblazoned with the logo of the Library Association and his own name, his proudest possession, was now a uniform shiny black, like a fax left out in the sun.

"You monster!" cried Mack.

"Now, Mr. Spire, it is my special privilege to revoke your membership from life!" Mack hear the distinctive click of the hammer of a blunderbuss being cocked. Being the traditional weapon of the librarian, it was no surprise Sherman had one in his office. Mack flung himself onto Daisy just as the shot shattered the window of the door. On the floor he felt Daisy's fragile body tremble beneath his own. Since she had not really been standing in front of the door the maneuver had been unnecessary, but it was still a nice place to end up, Mack reflected.

Daisy wrapped her cardiganned arms around Mack's neck and pulled him down even closer. "Whatever will we do now, Mack?" she breathed in his ear, a warm glow seemingly suffusing her entire body.

Mack grinned. "Oh, I've got an idea or two." He ran his hand up her side and her outstretched arm.

"Oh, Mack!" Daisy gasped. He yanked the wedding book from her hand and lept to his feet. "Oh? Mack?" Daisy gasped. But had already leapt through the broken window. Sherman furiously pressed at the panic button beneath the lip of his desk.

"Don't even bother, Librarian Fairweather." Mack smirked. "This reckoning is long overdue and you've got no renewals."

"What exactly do you think you're going to do, Mack? The power of one librarian means nothing to ILK. We've got branches conveniently located in every community in the world, like a 10,000 headed hydra."

"Even a 10,000 headed hydra can't exist without its evil heart." Mack moved forward to the front of the desk smugly. "And, you, Sherman, are that evil heart. Without the authority control of the Library of Congress the rest of the hydra will eat itself."

“Ah ha! And then where will your precious patrons be? Without ILK there is no library system at all!”

“That’s where you are wrong. There’s a library in the heart of each newborn babe and each dying octogenarian. Wherever a friend lends a friend a book there’s a library. Wherever dated magazines pile up in a waiting room there’s a library. Whenever someone leaves a newspaper on the bus when they are done reading it there’s a library. Right now there are children being born with an innate love of categorizing, storing and distributing information. Thanks to me they will grow up in a world where they haven’t been taught to withhold the best books behind the desk out of spite, to issue fines that only punish our most inquisitive minds just because they needed a few more days to finish reading, or to host book clubs for only the most boring, trite and insipid award-winning literary selections just to bore perspective readers to death and keep leisure reading as a secret pleasure for the literati.

“Corruption thy name is the International Library Konsortium. Vengeance, thy name is Mack Spire!”

“No, Mack!” Daisy screamed ineffectually. “Don’t do it! We could have been so happy together if we’d just ran away and forgotten that we’d ever even heard the word library!”

“You’re self-righteous sentiments are all very amusing,” Sherman laughed. “But you are still but one man standing against the mightiest institution in the world! What can you possibly do?”

Mack held up the Ludlum thriller in one hand and the wedding guide in the other and smiled grimly. Sudden realization sent a shock of horror across Sherman’s feature. “Oh my heavens, no! You wouldn’t! Even on our darkest day ILK would never…”

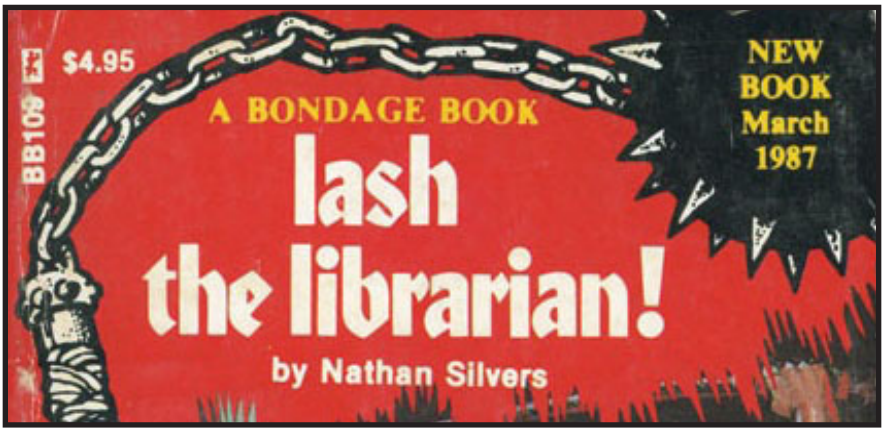
“That’s right. Even in your funhouse mirror conception of anti-librarianship there is still one taboo that cannot be condoned, one blasphemy that cannot be tolerated. As the Librarian of Congress, you are ultimately responsible for everything that gets shelved here.”

“Please, you can’t! You are a good man, a hero!”

“If you had any more time left I’d suggest you spend more time reading 20th century political thrillers. There are no heroes in this genre - only antiheroes.”

"No!" Sherman cried one last time. The explosive microchip all librarians have implanted at the base of their skulls upon Graduation from Library School suddenly seemed very big and very heavy and very hot. A trick of his mind, of course. The actual device was totally imperceptible but very deadly. The world seemed to move in slow motion as Mack's left hand moved the fiction book to the shelf just as his right hand placed the non-fiction book immediately adjacent. Such a fundamental shelving paradox could not be allowed to exist. The Dewey Policy, drilled into every librarian and programmed into every explosive microchip, was automatically activated. Daisy recoiled in horror as the interior of the office was lit up with twin fireballs. As the fire spread to the support beams the building began to moan and then wail with the weight of millions of books. Daisy knew the only possibility open to her now was escape. She ran screaming out into the lobby.

"We're free! We're free! We're so terribly, terribly free!" She slid to the ground sobbing against the nearest book drop, languidly slapping away the books the gathered crowd were trying to return to the slot. "Don't you see? There are no libraries anymore. There are no more librarians!" Her dire warnings were lost to the metallic swish-clunk of library books being returned and the neverending beeping of books being checked out. Swish-clunk-beep. Swish-clunk-beep, Swish-clunk-beep. In a strange way it almost sounded like a still-beating heart. A heart that would keep beeping no matter what anyone did. A titter escaped Daisy's mouth, then a guffaw, then uncontrollable cackling. She created quite the scene until a stern woman in a cat-themed sweatshirt came over to tell her politely but insistently that Daisy was no longer welcome… in the library!



The Librarians of Penzance

(These are the only remaining lyrics from "The Librarians of Penzance" an early draft of Gilbert and Sullivan's musical comedy which later gained fame as "The Pirates of Penzance".

Sadly, although several full songs were written, they were all destroyed after the well known duo decided to change the direction of their opera.)

I am the very model of a modern MLS Student,

I've information resources, both technological and traditional,

I know the class systems, and I quote the numbers logical

From Dewey to LOC, in order catalogical:

I'm very well acquainted, too, with matters organizational,

I understand the medias, both the old ones and the digital,

About taxonomies I'm teeming with a lot o' views,

With many cheerful facts about how they are so poorly used.

ALL: With many cheerful facts, etc.

Librarian: I'm Understanding of Information Users in Diverse Environments

[...]

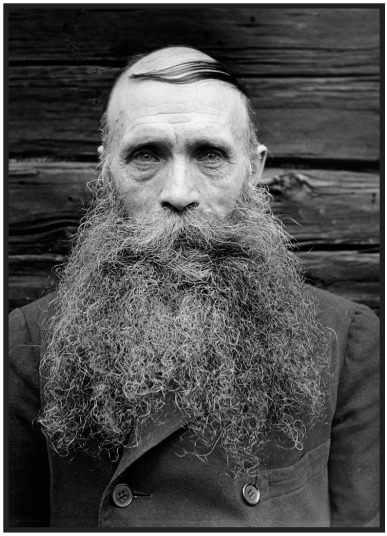
BE CAREFUL WHEN SHELVING THE ANCIENT FORBIDDEN EVIL.
by C. Frakes

END?

Bios

Colleen Frakes is an tireless, acrobatic monster historian who is ignorant of basic monster knowledge.

Her website is tragicrelief.com, and her twitter is @colleenfrakes.



Robert Perret is a rough-and-tumble, unathletic ambassador from the Fire Kingdom who is haunted by a ghost.

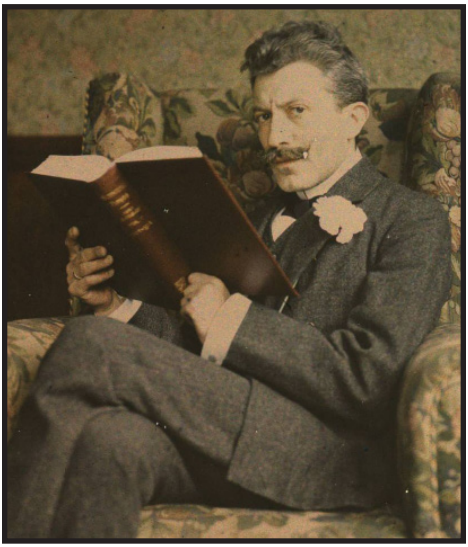
All bio images from the Flickr Commons: flickr.com/commons

Adena Brons is a tough, charismatic bear witch of memory and persuasion who is heir to an empire but doesn't know it.

Her website is adenabrons.wordpress.com.

Annie Gaines is a disorganized, sarcastic AI computer with a gift for understanding non-human languages.

Her twitter is @librariannies.



Matthew Murray is the rare good member of an otherwise irredeemably evil race whose culture has collapsed.

His website is thematthewmurray.weebly.com, and his twitter is @MidniteLibrary.

Don’t miss the first two issues of Two Fisted Librarians!

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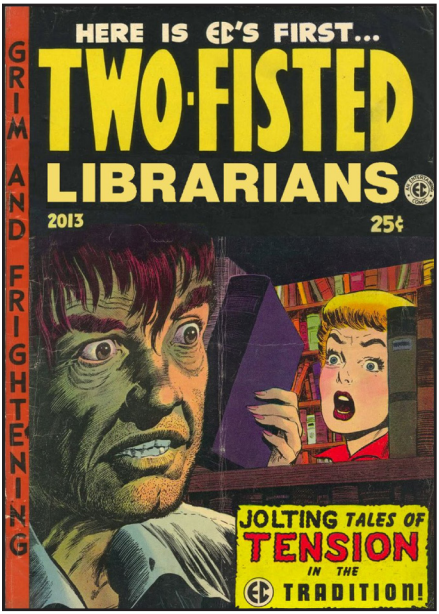

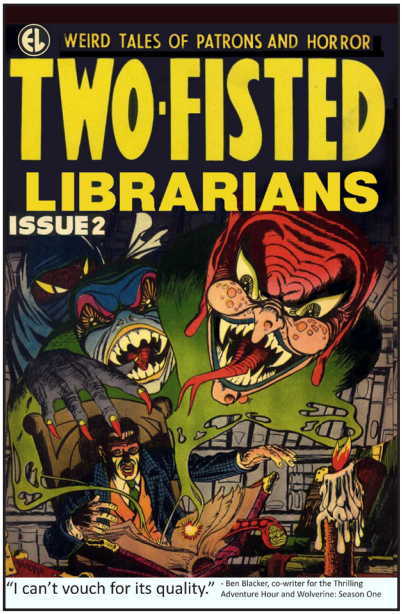

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WHAT IS CATALOGUED WRONG IS LOST!

REMEMBER!

BE CAREFUL WITH YOUR METADATA!